JAMES CHRISTOPHER RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Forward Deployed Engineer with 8 years of hands-on experience delivering infrastructure solutions across distributed teams. I've spent the last few years embedded with customer engineering teams, troubleshooting complex deployment scenarios and bridging the gap between product development and real-world implementation. I thrive in fast-paced environments where I'm wearing multiple hats, whether that's debugging production systems at 2am or architecting solutions from scratch. My background spans DevOps, cloud infrastructure, and on-site customer support, and I genuinely enjoy the chaos that comes with field engineering.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Graduate Systems Administrator

Vertex Solutions Ltd

vertex-solutions.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

August 2016 - November 2017

Managed and directed the infrastructure operations team of 23 engineers across three geographic regions

Architected enterprise-grade Kubernetes deployment strategy that scaled to support 500+ microservices

Led quarterly business reviews with Fortune 500 clients and negotiated £2.3m renewal contracts

Implemented automated compliance monitoring system reducing audit preparation time by 87%

Senior Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

CloudScale Technologies

www.cloudscale.io

London, United Kingdom

December 2017 - June 2021

Deployed and maintained containerized applications across AWS and Google Cloud Platform for 40+ enterprise customers

Engineered disaster recovery protocols and conducted quarterly failover testing with zero data loss incidents

Mentored team of 4 junior engineers on infrastructure best practices and led weekly technical training sessions

Reduced cloud infrastructure costs by 34% through resource optimization and reserved instance strategies

Forward Deployed Engineer

Catalyst Systems Group

www.catalystsystems.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

July 2021 - Present

Stationed at customer sites providing real-time technical support and custom configuration for complex distributed systems

Diagnosed and resolved critical production outages affecting 50+ concurrent deployments, maintaining 99.9% uptime SLA

Developed Python automation scripts and Terraform modules to streamline customer onboarding process

Collaborated with sales engineering team to identify and implement feature requests from forward deployed feedback

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

2014 - 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, Google Cloud Platform, Azure Virtual Machines

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Compose, Helm

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

Programming Languages: Python, Bash, Go, JavaScript

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, DataDog

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, MySQL

CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, CircleCI

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, Load Balancing, VPN Configuration

Operating Systems: Linux, CentOS, Ubuntu, macOS